for a heretic creates confusion in the minds of true believers. Therefore, a heretic must be shown no quarter and his ideas must be suppressed. That essentially has always been and still is the belief of the Catholic Church but its practice has been toned down to meet modern liberal notions. When the practice fitted in with the theory it led to the Spanish Inquisition, the *autos da fe* [act of faith], and various crusades and wars against Christian non-conformists in Europe. The Inquisition has a bad odour now and we shiver to think of its cruelties. Yet it was carried on by high-minded, deeply religious men who never thought of personal gain. They believed with all their intensity of religious conviction that the heretic would go to hell if he persisted in his error and with all their might they sought to save his immortal soul from the eternal pit. What did it matter if in this attempt the body was made to suffer?

Islam is obviously different from the Roman Catholic Church because it has no Pope, no regular priesthood and not so many dogmas. But I imagine that the general exclusive intolerant outlook is the same and it would approve of heresy hunts for the suppression of the evil before it spread. Cardinal Newman denying the nineteenth-century assumption of the progress of our race said that our races progress and perfectibility is a dream because revelation contradicts it.[33] Further, he said that it would be a gain to this country were it vastly more superstitious, more bigoted, more gloomy, more fierce in its religion than at present it shows itself to be. He was referring to England.

I wonder how far Sir Mohamad Iqbal would accept Cardinal Newman's dictum, applying to Islam of course. I imagine that quite a large number of both Hindus and Muslims would agree with the Cardinal, each thinking in terms of his own religion. Indeed, I should say that most truly religious people belonging to almost any organized religion would agree with him. Personally I entirely disagree with him because my outlook is not that of religion. But I think I can dimly understand the religious outlook and to some extent even appreciate it. Granting the supreme importance of certain dogmas and beliefs, the rest seems to follow. If I am absolutely convinced that a thing is evil it is absurd to talk about tolerating it. It must be